

Ἐπικά Ἀδέσποτα

Anonymous Epic Works from the Hellenistic Tradition

eul_aid: kjq

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Ἑπική [Epic \(Homeric\)](#) (frg)
Domain: Ἔπος [Epic](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Epica Adespota is a scholarly term for anonymous fragments of ancient Greek epic poetry. These pieces of verse, composed in the same dactylic hexameter as Homer's works, date from the Archaic period through the Hellenistic era, approximately the 8th to 3rd centuries BCE. They survive not as complete poems but as quotations preserved within the works of later ancient commentators, grammarians, and encyclopedists.

The fragments originate from a wide variety of lost epic poems. According to modern scholarship, they may include parts of the Epic Cycle, which narrated fuller stories of the Trojan War and other legends, as well as poems concerning local foundations, genealogies, or myths. Their anonymous status is largely an accident of history; they were preserved for their linguistic or mythological content rather than with attribution to their original poet.

These fragments are significant because they reveal the vast and diverse world of Greek epic beyond the famous works of Homer and Hesiod. They provide evidence for alternate versions of myths, local traditions, and the evolution of poetic language. For historians of literature, they are essential, if challenging, pieces for reconstructing the much larger landscape of early Greek poetry that has otherwise been lost.

Works (18)

- Ἐγκώμιον · [encom](#) · 2 passages
- Ἐγκώμιον εἰς Ἡράκλειον τὸν ἡγεμόνα · [encom-Heraclius the Leader](#) · 5 passages
- Ἐγκώμιον εἰς τὸν Ῥωμαῖον ἡγεμόνα · [encom-the Roman Leader](#) · 40 passages
- Ἐπικὸν Ἀπόσπασμα · [Epic Fragment](#) · 14 passages
- Ἠθοποιία · [Ethopoeic Exercise](#) · 2 passages
- Ἠθοποιία · [Ethopoeic Exercise](#) · 1 passages
- Ἠθοποιαί · [Ethopoeic Exercises](#) · 15 passages
- Ἱστορικὸν Ἐπικὸν Ἀπόσπασμα · [Historical Epic Fragment A](#) · 21 passages
- Ἱστορικὸν Ἐπικὸν Ἀπόσπασμα · [Historical Epic Fragment B](#) · 4 passages
- Ἰαμβικὸν Ἐγκώμιον · [Iambic encom](#) · 22 passages
- Λόγος ἐπιβατήριος · [Inaugural Speech](#) · 16 passages
- Ἑρμῆς ὁ Δημιουργὸς τοῦ Κόσμου καὶ Ἑρμοῦπολις · [Mercury the Creator of the World and Hermopolis Magna](#) · 32 passages
- Ποίημα περὶ τοῦ Νείλου ἀνατέλλοντος · [Poem-the Rising Nile](#) · 2 passages
- Πολυξένη καὶ Ἀχιλλεύς · [Polyxena and Achilles](#) · 1 passages

- Ἐγκώμιον Καθηγητοῦ ἐν Βηρύτῳ · Praise of a Professor Teaching at Berytus University · 2 passages
- Ἐγκώμιον Σμυρναίου Καθηγητοῦ ἐν Βηρύτῳ · Praise of a Smyrnaean Professor Teaching at Berytus University · 5 passages
- Ἐγκώμια Θεῶνος τοῦ Γυμνασιάρχου · Praises of Theon the Gymnasiarch · 3 passages
- Γαμήλιον ᾠσμα · Wedding Song · 1 passages